

be working in are difficult to prepare for, and worse yet, they can often be bait for MLM (multilevel marketing) or scams. In short, you should at least know if you'll be working in a restaurant, as compared to filing copies of credit applications. These are very different ball games, indeed.

2. They accept anyone

I once answered a job ad that replied with an interview appointment the same day. Since it was for a mid-level management position, I showed up in my best "interview suit" and brought extra résumés on linen paper. Looking around the reception area, I saw many other "prospects" for the same job I was interviewing for. Many were wearing sweats, and one guy didn't even speak English. I should have walked then, as they were obviously *not* looking for a mid-level manager, but door-to-door salesmen. Tricky.

3. They have no known address

This one seems obvious, but it took me by surprise. That same job I mentioned earlier with the vague address and a waiting room full of unqualified applicants didn't show up in my local phone book. The interview took place in an unmarked office building,

and there was no corporate branding anywhere inside or out. So I shouldn't have been shocked to find that it was a front for a door-to-door promotions company. When they told me I was hired, and asked if I would like to see the "operations side" of the manager position, I was taken by company car to the dumpy side of town to try to sell pizza coupons. *Yikes!*

4. They run the same job ad week after week (and the week after that)

Did you ever notice that some big companies run the exact same ad (with slightly different wording) almost regularly? There may not even be a job opening, but the high rate of turnover at these jobs almost guarantees they will be needing someone soon. Keeping a constant supply of new hires in the pipeline secures their chances of having someone trained and ready to work these jobs at any given time—if only for a few months.

5. A Google search turns up trash

I don't believe everything I read on the web, but I am inclined to seriously reconsider working for any company with their own "this company sucks